Newsletter March 2023

500 Women Scientists Bern-Fribourg

Today is March 8, and we celebrate International Women's Day! From our pod, we revindicate a gender equal society which must be free of bias, stereotypes and discrimination. Join us to collectively #EmbraceEquity.

We have collaborated with the Association of Spanish Scientists in Switzerland to promote the work of female scientists. Our pod members Ana I. Benítez Mateos and Andrea Fortier introduce their research work and our *500 Women Scientists* pod in this video! We also celebrate that Ana has been awarded a Spanish "Premios Manuela Forja" as a young female scientist from Cádiz (ES).

See more news below!

500 Women Scientist Bern-Fribourg Pod Coordinators
Claudia Kasper, Andrea Fortier and Ana I. Benítez-Mateos

TOP STORIES

500WS in the pub - February 2023

On the occasion of the International Day of Women and Girls in Science (February 11), we held our first pub event of the year at ONO Bern!

We had the pleasure to meet two invited speakers and get to know their research work.

Dr. Christina Kast from Agroscope shared her research on how pesticides can be monitored using honey bees.





Prof. Dr. Susanne Wampfler from the University of Bern explained the wonders of what planets, stars, and comets are made of.

Thanks to our pod members Sabnam, Silvia, Oksana, Iris and Andrea for organizing a wonderful evening full of science and games!





Evolutionary biology professor leaves University of Lausanne under “mysterious circumstances”

As reported by Science, evolutionary biologist Laurent Keller left the University of Lausanne on 6 February. **No reasons for his leaving were communicated** by UNIL. Another Science report from yesterday relates the case more directly to sexual harassment. The silence about this is very deplorable and makes it very difficult for people who experience similar things to defend themselves adequately. People directly involved in the case are not able to discuss the topic with us. An article (in French) by the francophone Swiss radio and television RTS with the title “Professor leaves UNIL as it tackles harassment issues” (translated to English) offers more clues about the case by establishing a temporal coincidence of his departure and **UNIL’s launching of a culture change to combat sexual harassment**, but is kept rather vague and unspecific. However, it seems that, after an audit revealed four rapes and nearly 150 cases of harassment at the institution last year, the rector of UNIL, Frédéric Herman, has made this issue a priority and sanctions have been taken against some employees for cases of harassment. The audit concluded that existing reporting capabilities are inefficient and lack confidence. New measures were launched as a reaction, such as regular surveys about work climate, and **mandatory training has been launched for incoming professors**. We are very pleased that apparently one of the demands from our letter “**Addressing gender inequality in Academia in Switzerland**” has been taken up.

READ

The women changing science in Switzerland, an article that portraits four women and their excellent scientific research in Swiss institutions.

SAVE THE DATE

14 June 2023

Join us for the Frauenstreik in Bern! More news about the activities will be announced soon on our social media!

YOU CAN JOIN OUR POD HERE


info@500womenscientistsfribourgbern.ch


www.500womenscientistsfribourgbern.ch


@500wsB


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